

YUNXIANG ZHANG

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EDUCATION

University of Michigan – Ann Arbor
Ph.D. in Computer Science and Engineering
Advisor: Prof. [Lu Wang](#)

08/2022 – 04/2027 (*Expected*)

Peking University
B.S. in Geographic Information Science
Advisor: Prof. [Xiaojun Wan](#)

09/2018 – 07/2022

EXPERIENCE

Research Scientist Intern at Meta MRS
Mentor: [Ping Yu](#), [Will Su](#)
Topic: reinforcement learning for coding agents

05/2026 – 08/2026

Applied Scientist Intern at Amazon AWS
Mentor: [Kang Zhou](#), [Haibo Ding](#)
Topic: reinforcement learning for machine learning agents

05/2025 – 08/2025

Research Intern at Microsoft Research
Mentor: [Xingdi Yuan](#), [Alessandro Sordoni](#)
Topic: reward model for LLM reasoning

05/2024 – 08/2024

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

1. [AdaMEM: Test-Time Adaptive Memory for Language Agents](#)
Yunxiang Zhang, Yiheng Li, Ali Payani, Lu Wang. In *Forty-Third International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML 2026)*.
2. [LiveOIBench: Can Large Language Models Outperform Human Contestants in Informatics Olympiads?](#)
Kaijian Zou, Aaron Xiong, **Yunxiang Zhang**, Xinliang Frederick Zhang, Yueqi Ren, Jirong Yang, Ayoung Lee, Shitanshu Bhushan, Lu Wang. In *Forty-Third International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML 2026)*.
3. [Logit Arithmetic Elicits Long Reasoning Capabilities Without Training](#)
Yunxiang Zhang, Muhammad Khalifa, Lechen Zhang, Xin Liu, Ayoung Lee, Xinliang Frederick Zhang, Farima Fatahi Bayat, Lu Wang. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2026 (Findings of ACL 2026)*.
4. [Skill-Aware Data Selection and Fine-Tuning for Data-Efficient Reasoning Distillation](#)
Lechen Zhang, **Yunxiang Zhang**, Wei Hu, Lu Wang. In *The 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL 2026)*.
5. [Learning to Ideate for Machine Learning Engineering Agents](#)
Yunxiang Zhang, Kang Zhou, Zhichao Xu, Kiran Ramnath, Yun Zhou, Sangmin Woo, Haibo Ding, Lin Lee Cheong. In *The 19th Conference of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (EACL 2026 Oral)*.
6. [MLRC-Bench: Can Language Agents Solve Machine Learning Research Challenges?](#)
Yunxiang Zhang, Muhammad Khalifa, Shitanshu Bhushan, Grant D Murphy, Lajanugen

- Logeswaran, Jaekyeom Kim, Moontae Lee, Honglak Lee, Lu Wang. In *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems 38: Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems 2025 (NeurIPS Datasets and Benchmarks Track 2025)*.
7. **Small Language Models Need Strong Verifiers to Self-Correct Reasoning**
Yunxiang Zhang, Muhammad Khalifa, Lajanugen Logeswaran, Jaekyeom Kim, Moontae Lee, Honglak Lee, Lu Wang. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2024 (Findings of ACL 2024)*.
 8. **Merging Generated and Retrieved Knowledge for Open-Domain QA**
Yunxiang Zhang, Muhammad Khalifa, Lajanugen Logeswaran, Moontae Lee, Honglak Lee, Lu Wang. In *Proceedings of the 2023 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP 2023 **Oral**)*.
 9. **SituatedGen: Incorporating Geographical and Temporal Contexts into Generative Commonsense Reasoning**
Yunxiang Zhang, Xiaojun Wan. In *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems 36: Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems 2023 (NeurIPS Datasets and Benchmarks Track 2023)*.
 10. **MOVER: Mask, Over-generate and Rank for Hyperbole Generation**
Yunxiang Zhang, Xiaojun Wan. In *Proceedings of the 2022 Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: Human Language Technologies (NAACL 2022 **Oral**)*.
 11. **Interpreting the Robustness of Neural NLP Models to Textual Perturbations**
Yunxiang Zhang, Liangming Pan, Samson Tan, Min-Yen Kan. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2022 (Findings of ACL 2022)*.
 12. **BiRdQA: A Bilingual Dataset for Question Answering on Tricky Riddles**
Yunxiang Zhang, Xiaojun Wan. In *Proceedings of the Thirty-Sixth AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI 2022)*.

HONORS & AWARDS

Silver Reviewer, International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)	2026
Travel Award, Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)	2025
Rackham Conference Travel Grant, University of Michigan	2023-2025
Rackham Professional Development Grant, University of Michigan	2023
Student Scholarship, AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence	2022
May 4th Scholarship, Peking University	2020
Robin Li Scholarship, Peking University	2019

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Co-Organizer, 1st Workshop on Test-Time Scaling and Reasoning Models, COLM 2025
Student Volunteer, ACL 2024
Reviewer: TMLR, ICML (2025-26), AISTATS (2025), ICLR (2025-26), NeurIPS (2024-25), ACL Rolling Review (2024-26), COLM (2024, 2026), EMNLP (2022-24), ACL (2023), CoNLL (2023-24), ACM Computing Surveys

SKILLS

Python, C/C++, SQL, Pytorch, Huggingface, L^AT_EX, Git, Vim, DeepSpeed, Ray, VeRL, vLLM